

CULTIVATING AI & DATA PRIVACY TRANSPARENCY

City of Long Beach, CA | Technology and Innovation Department / Technology, Planning, and Partnerships Division

Cassia Gray, Design Fellow | *Cal Poly San Luis Obispo , Graphic Communication*

Keywords:

user experience design, AI, data privacy, design system, content strategy

Summary:

Cassia led the design of AI and Data Privacy webpages for the City of Long Beach's Smart Cities website which increases effective transparency and **builds trust** around emerging technologies. Her information architecture prioritizes surfacing the most relevant information upfront and guides people to what they need quickly, while also supporting those who want to dive deeper. Pioneering the **City's first Figma-based workflow**, she built a reusable design system for the City's content management system from scratch and led a branding refresh to ensure consistency, sustainability, and alignment with accessibility standards. The final webpages serve as a **resource hub for 6,000+ City staff and 450,000+ Long Beach residents**.

CULTIVATING AI & DATA PRIVACY TRANSPARENCY AT THE CITY OF LONG BEACH

Technology and Innovation Department / Technology
Planning & Partnerships Division

City of Long Beach, CA

Malgosia Rejniak — Program Manager for AI and Data Governance

coding it forward >

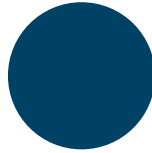
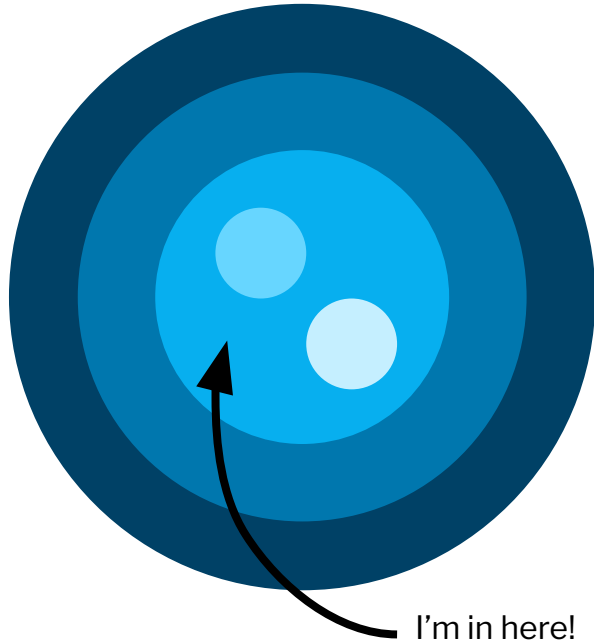


TECHNOLOGY
& INNOVATION
LONG BEACH

CASSIA GRAY
Cal Poly SLO
Graphic Communication

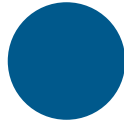
CONTEXT

WHERE I WORKED



The City of Long Beach, CA

450,000+ residents, 16,000+ employees



Technology and Innovation Department (TID)

Manages and supports the technology systems, infrastructure, and digital services across the City



Technology, Planning, and Partnerships Division (TPP)

Leads the Smart City initiative, which uses emerging technology to address civic challenges



Data Privacy Office

Protects and governs how the City handles residents' personal data



Artificial Intelligence Office

Guides how the City evaluates and uses artificial intelligence in its services

ABOUT TPP

Long Beach is a leader in digital governance

- Named the top Digital City in the nation for the 5 years

Expanding TPP to include data privacy and AI initiatives

- Received AI 50 Award from the Center for Public Sector AI
- Exploring emerging tech, protecting through governance, educating residents and staff

CURRENT STATE

Currently, the AI and Data privacy initiative documentation is buried at the bottom of the “Projects” page of the website without much context.

This makes it hard for people to find.

Also, the Smart City Initiative Website is also outdated and not ADA compliant



THE PROBLEM

Uninformed

61% of residents not at all and 59% of staff slightly to somewhat informed about the City's generative AI use



Concerned

46% of residents are concerned about the City's AI usage



Information and trust gap

43% of residents are not sure if they can trust the City to be transparent and accountable in how it collects and uses personal data

MY ROLE

My role as a Design Fellow was to research and design new AI and Data Privacy webpages for the City's Smart Cities Initiative website to improve transparency around the initiatives and help bridge this trust gap.

AND

Provide recommendations for a Smart City Initiative website redesign

PROCESS



Discover

Material review
Survey review
Stakeholder meetings
Target audience
HMW



Decide

Comparative analysis
User journey mapping
Design principles
Sitemapping



Make

Design system
Wireframes
Prototype



Validate

Augmented usability testing
Preference testing



Refine

Iterate!



DISCOVER

Understanding the problem and the people it impacts

FAMILIARIZING

- Meeting with internal stakeholders to understand their priorities and goals
- Reviewing 40+ resources



TARGET AUDIENCES



Residents

Individuals and families living in Long Beach curious about the City's initiatives and their impact



City Employees

Staff members of the City's departments curious about the City's initiatives and how to get involved with them



Vendors

Entrepreneurs who are interested in proposing tech or collaborating to create tech for the City

How might we design webpages to increase understanding of the City's AI and Data Privacy initiatives and help close the information and trust gap between the City?



DECIDE

Creating frameworks that will support the design process

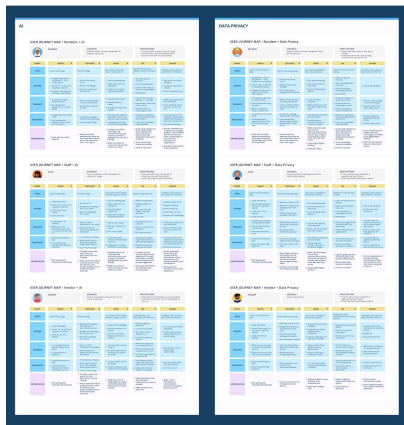
COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

Analyzed how other local government offices and public institutions communicate AI and data privacy to identify effective content and design patterns:

- **Language** - use concise and casual plain language, pair high-level principles with direct examples of how they are used and applied
- **Visuals** - use visuals to aid information processing not decoration
- **Hierarchy** - prioritize actionable information and resources early, values later
- **Interactivity** - cards, accordions, and contextual links for progressive disclosure
- **Text** - short chunked text blocks, bullets in moderation to support scanning

USER JOURNEY MAPPING

6 user journey maps - by audience member for AI and data privacy



USER JOURNEY MAP / Staff + AI

STAFF		SCENARIO	EXPECTATIONS		
		City of Long Beach Staff interested in AI initiative or usage	- Know what the City is doing with AI - Know how City staff are using AI - Know how to get involved internally		
STAGES	SEARCH	DISCOVERY	LEARN	DIG	ENGAGE
GOALS	Look for the AI page	Find the AI page	Learn about the AI initiative and how it applies to them	Explore usage resources	Complete a call to action to stay involved or informed
ACTIONS	1. Check TID website 2. Search "AI" on the City of Long Beach website 3. Check Smart Cities website 4. Check Intranet	1. Find AI on TID 2. Navigate to AI webpage from Smart cities 3. Find the AI webpage from search	1. Skim the landing page 2. Read chunks that are interesting 3. Find Staff related information 4. Explore by clicking on expanding elements	1. Watch training videos 2. Review guidelines in depth 3. View use cases and relate to personal workflow 4. Use cases	1. Request copilot access 2. Request a training 3. Join AI workgroup 4. Submit their use case 5. Propose an AI technology
THOUGHTS	1. Do we have an AI initiative? 2. Where can I find information about how I'm supposed to be using AI?	1. Where is all the information in one place? 2. What department/division would have this information	1. How are we using it? 2. How am I supposed to use it? 3. Am I using it right?	1. How does this look in practice? 2. How can I improve my workflow? 3. Do I need to use AI?	1. I'd like to get updated on this information 2. There are things I'd like to know that aren't on here
PAIN POINTS	1. Doesn't know where to look 2. Can't differentiate between staff and public resources	1. AI not listed on TID page 2. Don't know to look on Smart Cities website/ doesn't know about it 3. Can't find the AI page	1. Can't differentiate between staff and public resources 2. Language is confusing and doesn't feel relevant	1. Information provided doesn't feel relevant to staff member's position 2. Expectations around usage are confusing	1. Confusion about if the newsletter will give them information they want or also have irrelevant info 2. No place for feedback
OPPORTUNITIES	1. SEO optimization internally and externally	1. Consider a more clear way to link to AI information from the TID page 2. Inform staff internally of a website launch or use the website as the primary landing area for AI info distributed internally	1. Consider what is the most high level information they need to know, and how to highlight that to be skim friendly 2. Make sure impact is woven into the way that content is written	1. Consider that not everyone feels morally aligned with AI usage - be friendly to multiple levels of adoption and provide suggestions 2. Encourage involvement for those who have more questions	1. Ensure that people know how to get involved and the requirements of that involvement: staff workgroup meets X amt of times per X 2. Encourage staff members to share their experiences

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

1

Understandable

Design content anyone can digest by using plain language and clear structure.

2

Transparent

Present all our information and guide people to it without overwhelming them.

3

Relevant

Support people's curiosity by providing the right information and resources at the right moments.

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Help people understand at a high level and support them in diving deeper. People want to quickly identify what's relevant to them, and trust that when they click, they'll find exactly what they expected.

By audience

Signal what information is useful to what audience

By interest

Categorize information and resources by what questions they answer

cif>



Content Items ▾

Sections

Subpages

Pages

Audience Types ▾

Principle ▾

Resources ▾

Tools ▾

Grid View ▾

Hide fields

Filter

Grouped by 2 fields

LT Sort

Color

Share and sync

	A Header Copy	Element	Draft Body Copy	Section	Subpage (from...	Audience Types...			Resources	Page (from...
9	Support AI Implementation	Accordion Item		AI Strategy	AI Home	Residents	Vendors	City	AI	
10	View AI Strategy PDF	Button		AI Strategy	AI Home	Residents	Vendors	City	AI	
SECTION										
▾	How Long Beach is Using	3								
11	How Long Beach is using ...	Section Header	Learn about our standard...	How Long Beach is Using A	AI Home	Residents	Vendors	City	AI	
12	Our AI Standards	Card	Learn about the policies, ...	How Long Beach is Using A	AI Home	Residents	Vendors	City	AI	
13	Shape Our AI Technologies	Card	Discover how to collabora...	How Long Beach is Using A	AI Home	Residents	Vendors	City	AI	
SUBPAGE (FROM SUBJECT)										
▾	Our AI Standards	17								
SECTION										
▾	About	1								
14	Our AI Standards	Header Banner	Learn about the policies, ...	About	Our AI Standards	City Employees	Residents		AI	
SECTION										
▾	AI Policy	7								
15	AI Inventory and Approval...	Section Header		AI Policy	Our AI Standards	City Employees	Residents	Digital Rights Platform	AI	
16	The City Must Maintain a ...	List Item	We publish all AI systems ...	AI Policy	Our AI Standards	City Employees	Residents	Digital Rights Platform	AI	



MAKE

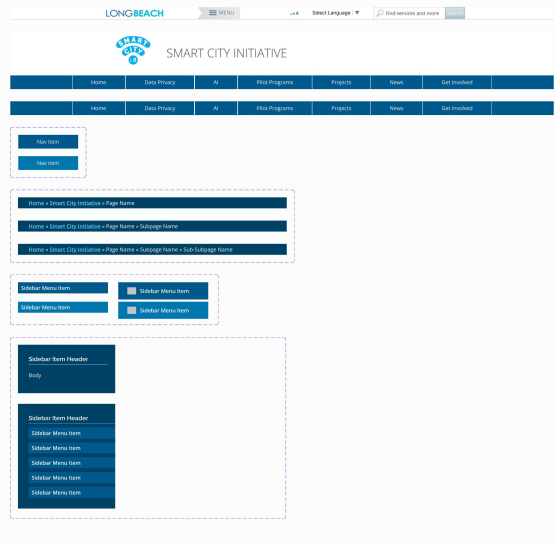
Designing a testable solution

cif>

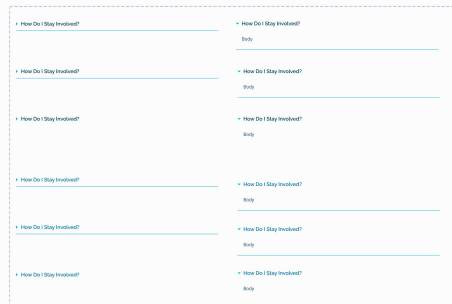
[illegible]

DESIGN SYSTEM – TRANSLATING THE CMS

NAVIGATION



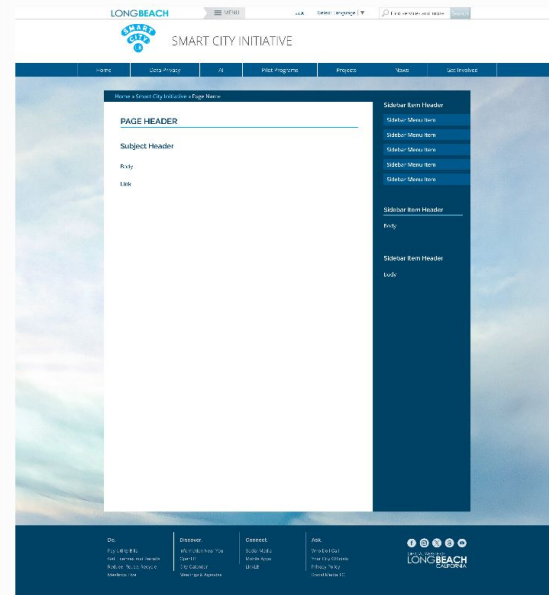
ACCORDION



TYPOGRAPHY

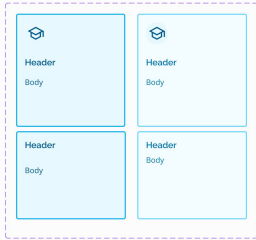


TEMPLATES



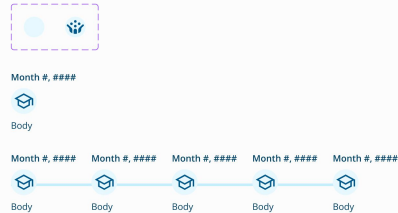
DESIGN SYSTEM – NEW COMPONENTS

CARDS



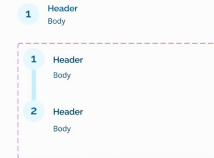
Custom code

TIMELINE

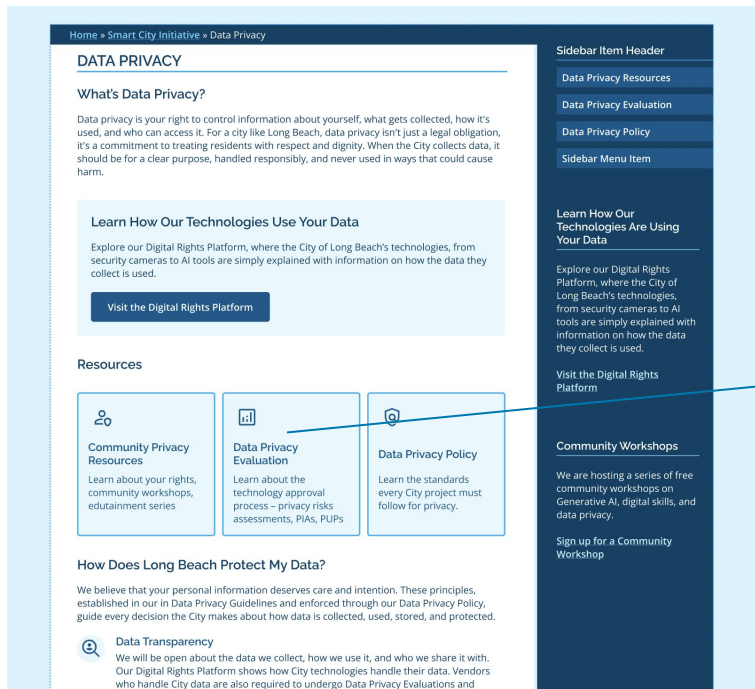


Working within CMS constraints

LISTS



WIREFRAMES - DATA PRIVACY



DATA PRIVACY EVALUATION

What Is A Privacy Evaluation?

A process required [Long Beach Data Privacy Policy](#) to classify the risk associated with a technology, information system, or application.

[Download the Privacy Evaluation PDF](#)

Completed Privacy Evaluations

Completed Evaluations are published for public review on the [Digital Rights Platform](#) or below:

Date	Name	Risk	Links
8/2025	CommsCoach	High	CommsCoach Digital Rights Entry CommsCoach PIA CommsCoach PUP
00/0000	Wingspans	Mid	Wingspans Digital Rights Entry Wingspans PIA
00/0000	SpeedCams	High	SpeedCams Digital Rights Entry SpeedCams PIA

The Evaluation Process

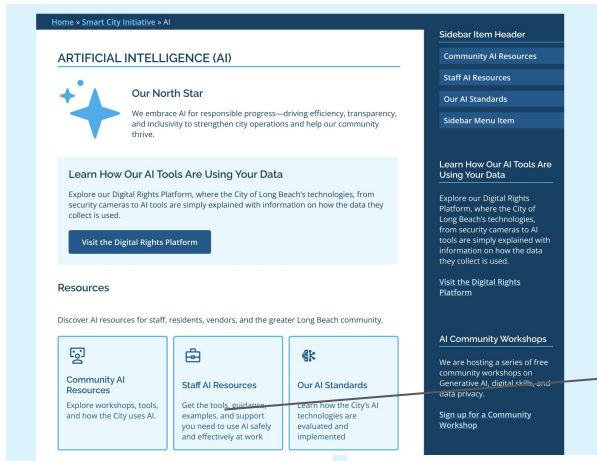
This process should take 1-4 months depending on risk.

1 Proposal

The process begins when a City department engages TID during the procurement, program development, or policymaking stage. To initiate, departments submit a "Privacy Evaluation" helpdesk ticket in Spark. Including the following:

- Technology / project purpose
- The type of data involved
- Who will access the data (City staff, public, third parties)

WIREFRAMES - AI



AI Strategy

Click to see how we apply our **AI Strategy** key initiatives in our work.

- 1 Establish An AI Governance Framework**
Body
- 2 Build Community & Public Trust**
Ensuring the City's residents can use AI safely and responsibly to better their personal and professional lives, preventing the emergence of a digital divide
- 3 Strengthen City AI Capacity**
Empowering the City's workforce with the skills, tools, and resources to use AI technologies safely and effectively
- 4 Support AI Implementation**
Enabling thoughtful adoption of AI tools through launching pilots, conducting risk assessments, and developing responsible procurement practices

Copilot Rollout

City Staff can now use MS Copilot Chat in their workflows.

Sign up for Copilot access
Sign up for a Copilot Training

Home » Smart City Initiative » Staff AI Resources

STAFF AI RESOURCES

We Are Strengthening AI Capacity

Key Initiative 3 of our **AI Strategy** empowers the City's workforce with the skills, tools, and resources to use AI technologies safely and effectively. Here you can access AI training resources including Copilot tutorials, Gen AI training presentations, and hands-on learning opportunities.

Use AI At Work

Generative AI Guidance

The City has published official **Generative AI Guidance** for staff on the responsible use of Generative AI tools. This guidance covers approved uses, prohibited activities, and best practices for safe and effective AI use.

Microsoft Copilot Training

Copilot is the City's approved AI assistant inside Microsoft 365. It can help you draft content, summarize documents, analyze information, and prepare materials faster—all within our secure environment. Learn how to use Microsoft Copilot for Enterprise to improve your productivity while keeping City data secure.

Sign Up for Copilot Training

Gen AI Use Cases

Below details five general use cases identified from City staff. Each use case contains unique example prompts, helpful don'ts, and ways to mitigate AI bias.

- » Writing
- » Data Analytics
- » Translating
- » Coding



VALIDATE

Testing the design solution

USER INTERVIEWS

I virtually interviewed 4 City of Long Beach Staff and screen shared the prototype. I want to both test the effectiveness of the:

Content and design patterns

- Language
- Visuals
- Hierarchy
- Interactivity
- Text

AND

Design principles

- 1 Understandable
- 2 Transparent
- 3 Relevant

AUGMENTED USABILITY TESTING

1 Understandable

Goal: People can quickly discern what each page is about, how content is organized, and what everything means

Top Friction Points:



Data Privacy Evaluation

Learn about the technology approval process – privacy risks assessments, PIAs, PUPs

People didn't know what it meant

2 Transparent

Goal: People can easily find the information they seek. People find what they expect to find when they click on something.

Top Friction Points:

Learn How Our Technologies Use Your Data

Explore our Digital Rights Platform, where the City of Long Beach's technologies, from security cameras to AI tools are simply explained with information on how the data they collect is used.

[Visit the Digital Rights Platform](#)

People couldn't find it

AI Strategy

Click to see how we apply our AI Strategy key initiatives in our work.

- 1. Establish an AI Governance Framework**
Developing clear guidelines and policies governing the responsible use of AI across all City departments.
- 2. Build Community & Public Trust**
Ensuring the City's residents can use AI safely and responsibly to better their personal and professional lives, preventing the emergence of a digital AI divide.
- 3. Strengthen City AI Capacity**
Empowering the City's workforce with the skills, tools, and resources to use AI technologies safely and effectively.
- 4. Support AI Implementation**
Enabling the strategic adoption of AI tools through benchmarking, conducting risk assessments, and developing responsible procurement practices.

Expectations ≠ reality

3 Relevant

Goal: People feel that the most important information is surfaced first. People get information at the time they need it.

Friction Points:

People had contrasting ideas about what information was most important

PREFERENCE TESTING



Option A:

Learn How Our Technologies Use Your Data

Explore our Digital Rights Platform, where the City of Long Beach's technologies, from security cameras to AI tools are simply explained with information on how the data they collect is used.

[Visit the Digital Rights Platform](#)

Option B:

Digital Rights Platform

Explore our Digital Rights Platform, where the City of Long Beach's technologies, from security cameras to AI tools are simply explained with information on how the data they collect is used.

[Learn How Our Technologies Use Your Data](#)

Option A - more transparent



Option A:

How To Use AI At Work

We encourage individual City staff use of Gen AI to enhance productivity. The City has published official **Generative AI Guidance** for staff on the responsible use of Generative AI tools. This guidance covers approved uses, prohibited activities, and best practices for safe and effective AI use.

Discover AI resources for staff, residents, vendors, and the greater Long Beach community.

1 Use MS Copilot Chat

Copilot is the City's approved AI assistant inside Microsoft 365. To gain access to it, you must:

- Review the **Generative AI Guidance**
- Complete **MS Copilot Training**
- Fill out the **Acknowledgement Form**
- Access Copilot at [m365copilot.com](#)

To sign up for a "Gen AI Guidance 101" session for your department or team, fill out the **Generative AI Log Form**

2 Don't Share Private Information

Do not submit sensitive City information or private information of any individual or entity to Gen AI systems under review, such as ChatGPT, GoogleGemini, or Claude.

3 Carefully Review, Verify, And Fact-Check

Content generated by AI must be checked by multiple sources to eliminate instances of bias, offensive, inaccurate, or harmful material.

4 Cite Gen AI Usage

You are encouraged to cite or reference within your documents and share with TID via this the **Generative AI Log Form** when you use Gen AI for particularly impactful and/or creative use cases. Citations for content created by Gen AI should be in the form of a statement within your document or as a footnote, endnote, or header:

- In-text citation example: "This report summary was drafted with support from (GEN AI SYSTEM) on DD/MM/YYYY. The content was edited for accuracy and brevity and fact-checked by City staff."
- Footnote/endnote/header example: (GEN AI SYSTEM, DD/MM/YYYY. Fact checked by City staff and edited for accuracy and brevity.)

5 Do Not Use AI Meeting Assistants

Do not use AI meeting assistant outside of the transcription functionality provided within MS Teams and request that external collaborators turn off these tools in meetings with you.

6 Want To Contract And AI Tool?

If you are considering negotiating a contract with a Gen AI provider or using a Gen AI tool not mentioned in this Guidance, you must **contact TID**.

Option B:

Use AI At Work

Generative AI Guidance

The City has published official **Generative AI Guidance** for staff on the responsible use of Generative AI tools. This guidance covers approved uses, prohibited activities, and best practices for safe and effective AI use.

Microsoft Copilot Training

Copilot is the City's approved AI assistant inside Microsoft 365. To gain access to it, you must:

- Review the **Generative AI Guidance**
- Complete **MS Copilot Training**
- Fill out the **Acknowledgement Form**
- Access Copilot at [m365copilot.com](#)

To sign up for a "Gen AI Guidance 101" session for your department or team, fill out the **Generative AI Log Form**

Option B - more relevant

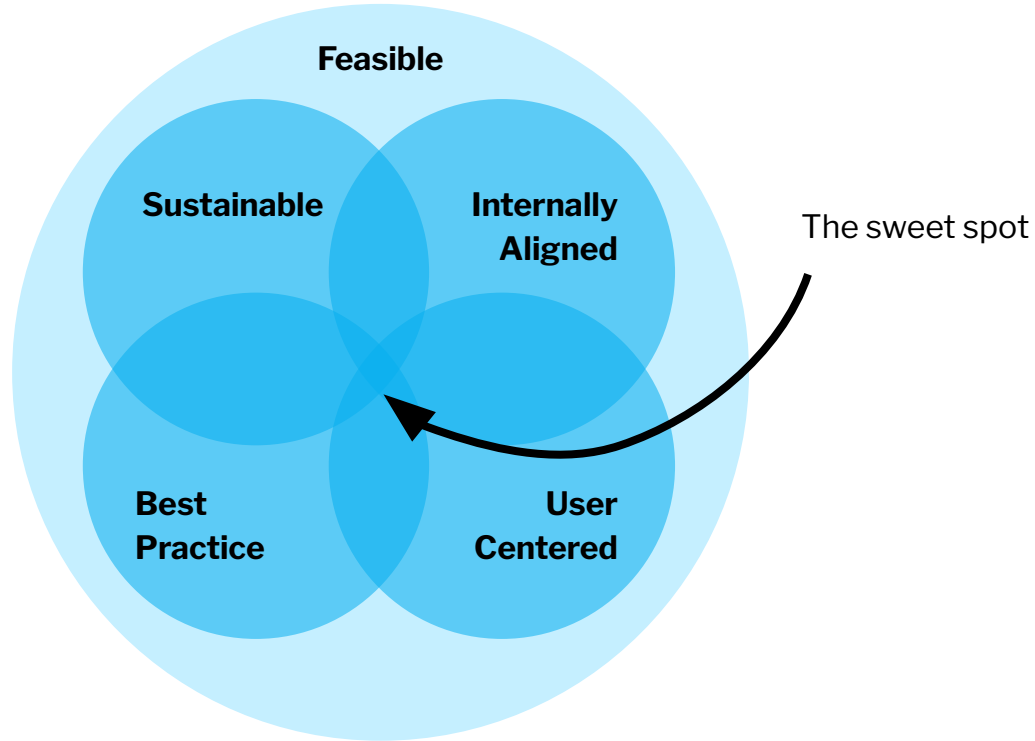
Option A - more understandable



REFINE

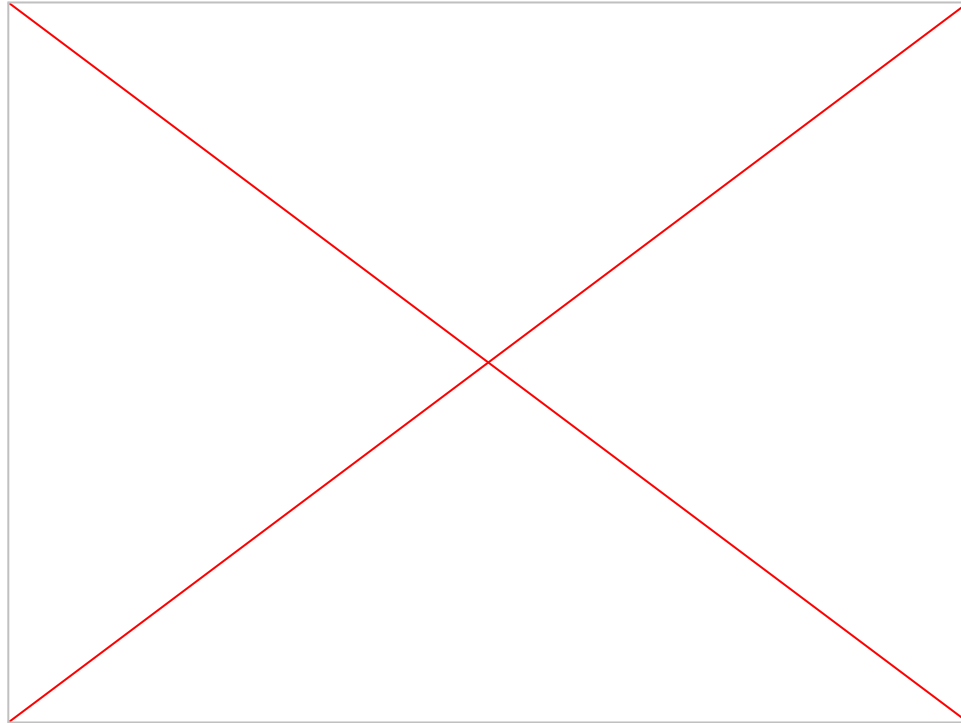
Integrating research findings, making final decisions, and polishing

DECISIONS...DECISIONS



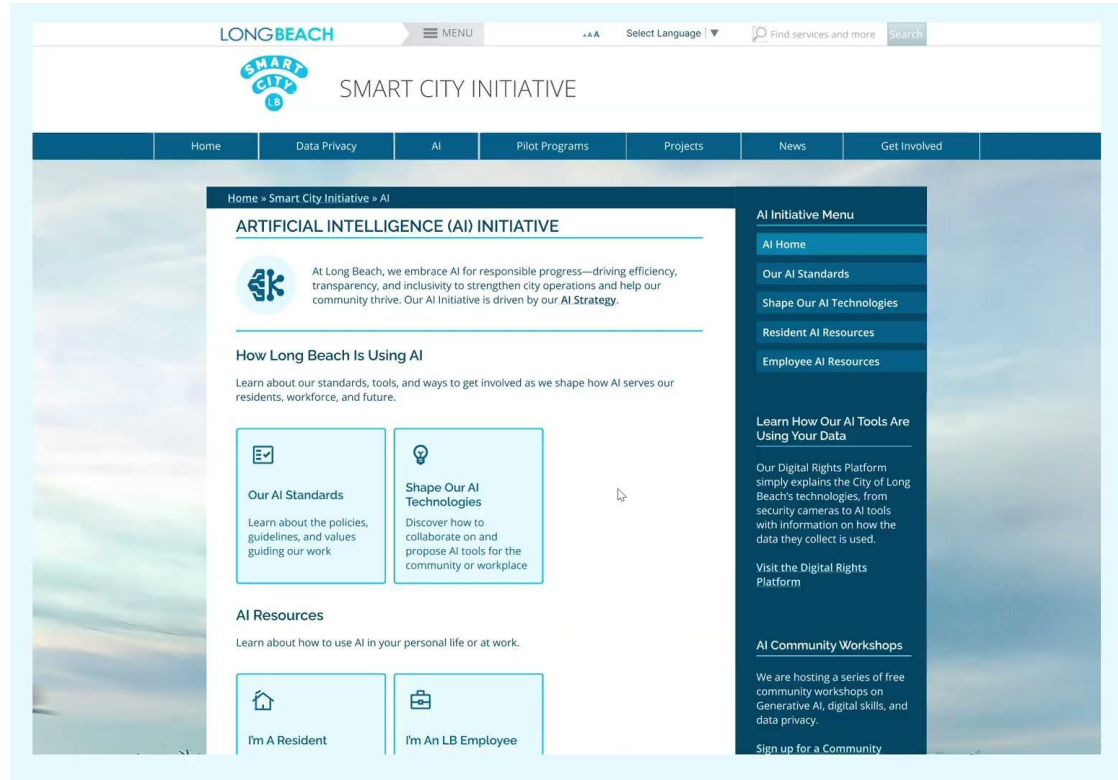
FINAL DESIGNS – DATA PRIVACY

[Long Beach Smart
City Initiative Web
Prototype](#)



FINAL DESIGNS - AI

Long Beach Smart City Initiative Web Prototype



NEXT STEPS

- Dev site revisions
- Content writing
- Smart City Initiative website redesign
 - Follow the same design framework
 - User research sessions with residents
 - Apply the new design system
- Tracking web analytics to see impact

TAKEAWAYS

1

Navigating constraints

Pressure testing which constraints, technical or systematic, are fixed or can be bended

2

Leaning on community

Use tried and true methods and resources from those who've been doing the work

3

Communicating across disciplines

Understanding the priorities and language of internal stakeholders

THANK YOU

Thank you to Malgosia, the TPP team, CIF, my mentor Jenn, the civic tech community, and my family for the support!